again. What would I have done if it hadn't just happened to have been a Friday and I could not have sung hymns and eaten salami?

3

On Saturday, November 3, the recruits all took a sort of intelligence test given by the Army. I believe it is called the AGCT score.

There were five tests. There was one on reading and vocabulary, two on mathematics, one on pattern analyses—and all these were familiar territory to me. The fifth one was brand-new. We were taught the Morse signal for three different letters and then had to reproduce the letters as the signal sounded, faster and faster and faster.

I welcomed that, to my surprise. It was hypnotic. I scarcely had to concentrate. My fingers did it all by themselves.

The whole thing took three hours and I enjoyed it. It was something that represented what my whole life had been.

Then we sent our civilian clothes home (I called them "civvies" in the diary, for I was picking up soldier slang) and got a haircut in which the barber merely hacked off all the hair that was more than an inch from my scalp. When I finally looked too ugly to be a civilian he knew he was done.

By then, I had made the acquaintance of two nearby soldiers and discovered that every Army post had movies, first-run, at a reasonable charge. So I went Saturday night—and Sunday night, too.

4

On Monday, November 5, we were marched to a building where our AGCT scores were to be analyzed and we were to be interviewed. This was in line with the theory that the Army would place you in a

position best suited for you. (If you showed great aptitude for geology you could dig trenches; for chemistry, you could be a cook; and so on.)

I waited in line as we were called and eventually I realized I had to visit the men's room and I happened to be standing right at the men's room door. I asked the sergeant who was supervising our slow advance if I could step into the men's room. Very reluctantly (for all requests by privates are to be refused as a matter of principle) he agreed, but warned me not to take too long.